



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: 20 March 2025	Entry: 1
Description	Received a report of a critical security incident at a small U.S. health care clinic specializing in primary-care services. Employees reported a widespread inability to access files, including medical records, and a ransom note demanding payment for file decryption. The incident seems to have originated from a phishing attack that led to the deployment of ransomware, causing severe disruptions in business operations.
Tool(s) used	None
The 5 W's	● Who caused the incident? ● An organized group of unethical hackers, as indicated in the ransom note. Further investigation needed to identify specific individuals or entities. ● What happened? ● A phishing attack targeted employees with a malicious attachment, leading to the deployment of ransomware that encrypted critical files. The attackers demanded a ransom for the decryption key.

	• When did the incident occur? • Tuesday morning at approximately 9:00 a.m. Further details on the timeline of the attack and the duration of the disruption are needed. • Where did the incident happen? • At a small U.S. health care clinic specializing in primary-care services. The specific location of the clinic needs to be documented for further investigation. • Why did the incident happen? • The incident occurred due to the successful execution of a phishing attack. The attackers gained access to the organization's network, deployed ransomware, and demanded a ransom. Motivations behind the attack, whether financial or otherwise, are yet to be determined.
Additional notes	1. How could the health care company prevent an incident like this from occurring again? 2. Should the company pay the ransom to retrieve the decryption key? 3. What immediate actions should be taken to contain the incident and minimize further damage? Prioritize a comprehensive analysis of the phishing attack vectors and the ransomware deployed. Initiate containment measures to prevent further spread and damage. Establish communication protocols with relevant stakeholders, including affected employees and authorities. Coordinate with law enforcement and cybersecurity experts to trace the attackers and assess the viability of paying the ransom.

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The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who caused the incident? • What happened? • When did the incident occur? • Where did the incident happen? • Why did the incident happen?
Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

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Need another journal entry template?

If you want to add more journal entries, please copy one of the tables above and paste it into the template to use for future entries.

Reflections/Notes: Record additional notes.
